

# Saada Amadu

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## EDUCATION

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- Ph.D.**      **City and Regional Planning, University of California, Berkeley, 2024–Present**  
*Concentration: Food Systems and Applied Data Science*  
*Designated Emphasis in Political Economy*
- M.S.**      **Environmental Sciences & Policy, Central European University, Budapest, Hungary, 2017**  
*Thesis: From Land Grabbing to Sustainable Land Investments: Effects of Large-Scale Land Transactions on the Environment and Rural Livelihoods in Ghana*
- B.A.**      **International Studies, College of Staten Island, New York, NY, 2016**  
*Honors Thesis: State and Non-Governmental Organization Influences on Sustainable Agricultural Practices in Senegal*  
*Study abroad: Université Paris Ouest Nanterre La Défense (2015), City University of Hong Kong (2016)*

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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- University of California, Berkeley — Graduate Student Instructor** **Fall 2025**  
• Assisted with mini lectures, assignments, and demos  
• Taught 2 sections of 30 students and grading

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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- Export Trading Group — Agribusiness Intern, Malawi** **May 2025 – Aug. 2025**  
• Conducted technical due diligence and sustainability assessments on agroforestry carbon-credit projects for 2,000+ smallholder farmers, modeling carbon sequestration potentials and designing revenue-share frameworks to attract impact investors.  
• Designed a Climate Desk toolkit and accompanying visuals for smallholder farmers on carbon credits, soil-health benefits, and revenue projections.
- Resilient Cities Network — Program Manager, Climate Resilience & Equity, New York** **Jun. 2022 – Aug. 2024**  
• Collaborated with city officials, community-based organizations, and stakeholders to identify and scale community-centric resilience solutions addressing climate risks and socioeconomic inequities.  
• Designed and conducted household surveys and key informant interviews across 250+ households, informing tailored interventions for extreme heat and flooding in four frontline environmental justice communities.  
• Conducted pre-feasibility studies and identified 10 viable climate resilience projects, leading to the selection and initiation of 5 projects with a combined budget of \$500,000, benefiting over 10,000 urban residents.  
• Led the Urban Eats campaign to inspire cities to adopt circular and resilient food systems and attract funding support.  
• Spearheaded the technical development and global deployment of the Resilient Infrastructure for Diversity and Equity (RIDE) Scorecard across 10 cities, with potential to impact over 2 million urban residents.
- Matriark Foods — Project Consultant, New York** **Oct. 2021 – Mar. 2022**  
• Researched and recommended vegetables and producers in line with sustainable sourcing criteria, and conducted upcycled foods market research to inform go-to-market strategy.  
• Designed and implemented company-wide environmental, social, and governance (ESG) reporting processes.
- Sky High Farm — Food Access Program Consultant, New York** **May 2021 – Oct. 2021**

- Utilized sustainable agriculture practices to produce food for distribution to the food-insecure.
- Conducted needs assessments and collaborated with community organizations on food security initiatives.

#### **Rethink Food — Policy Researcher, New York**

**Feb. 2020 – Apr. 2021**

- Co-led strategic development and execution of Rethink Food's food policy strategy, legislative agenda, and revenue goals.
- Facilitated 30+ strategic partnerships with restaurants, directing funding and resources to combat food insecurity.
- Led targeted lobbying and advocacy campaigns, liaising with elected officials and community leaders.
- Identified viable government funding opportunities and prepared grant applications and contract proposals.

#### **Spaces — Community Manager, New York**

**Dec. 2018 – Jan. 2020**

- Co-managed a seven-floor co-working space with over 100 companies.
- Built an active community through client programming; partnered with intergovernmental agencies on pitch competitions and coordinated logistics across five events with 300+ attendees.

#### **Schneider Electric — Sustainability Analyst, Budapest**

**Jan. 2018 – Aug. 2018**

- Oversaw sustainability reporting for 15 companies, achieving a 10% reduction in energy consumption and 15% reduction in carbon emissions.
- Managed 20+ electricity and gas utility vendors and researched climate policy and compliance strategies for clients.

#### **Impact Hub Budapest — Community Host, Budapest, Hungary**

**Feb. 2017 – Jul. 2017**

- Welcomed co-working members and space guests; fostered connections between community members to support innovation.

## **HONORS AND AWARDS**

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**Mentored Research Award (Full Tuition and Stipend), UC Berkeley**

**2026–2027**

**Center for African Studies Rocca Pre-dissertation Research Award, UC Berkeley**

**Summer 2026**

**Berkeley Economy and Society Initiative Award**

**Summer 2026**

**Chancellor's Fellowship (Full Tuition and Stipend), UC Berkeley**

**2024–2025**

**Central European University Research Travel Grant**

**2017**

**Central European University Master's Excellence Scholarship (Full Tuition and Stipend)**

**2016**

**Benjamin A. Gilman International Scholarship**

**2016**

**Benjamin Franklin Travel Grant**

**2015**

**Dean's List, College of Staten Island**

## **CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS**

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**Association of American Geographers Annual Meeting**

**2026**

*"What Do You Mean You Have No Forex?": Foreign Exchange Shortages, Food Security, and Economic Development in Landlocked Malawi — Accepted and Presented*

**Oxford Food Symposium**

**2026**

*"From Poverty Food to Global Superfood: Can Fonio Escape the Quinoa Trap?" — Accepted and Presented*

**Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics**

**2026**

*"Quinoa and Teff Ran so Fonio Could Walk: Beyond the Superfood Cycle and Toward a Proactive Political Economy of Fonio and Underutilized Species" — Accepted*

## **SKILLS**

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**Languages:** English (Native), Dagbanli (Native), Twi (Proficient), Hausa (Proficient), French (Elementary)

**Research Methods:** Household Surveys, Focus Groups, Key Informant Interviews, Participant Observation

**Technology:** Microsoft Office, G Suite, ArcGIS, SPSS

**Project Management:** Asana, Miro, Airtable